Technical and Business Writing

Mid Long Questions (4 marks each) · Simple English, matched to the slides and notes

#	Long question	Source	Priority
1	Writing Situation: Audience, Purpose, Context	Unit 1 · Lecture 1 · Lecture 2	Must do
2	7 Cs of Communication	7 Cs notes	Must do
3	Email Writing	Lecture 1 · Class work	Must do
4	General vs Technical vs Business Writing	Lecture 1 · Unit 1	Backup
5	Technical Writing Process	Lecture 2 · Unit 1	Backup

How to write a 4-mark long: Introduction (1–2 lines) → Table or points → One example → Conclusion (1 line).

LONG 1: Writing Situation (Audience, Purpose, Context)

Unit 1 (1.2) · Lecture 1 (slides 5, 20–21) · Lecture 2 (slide 7)

Q. Explain the writing situation: audience, purpose and context.

Introduction

Before writing, a writer must ask **three questions**: Who will read it? Why am I writing? Where will it be read? This is called the **writing situation**.

1. Audience: Who will read it?

Different readers know different things and need different things. There are 4 types:

Audience	What they want
Experts	Data and proof
Technicians	Clear steps
Managers	Short summary, cost and risks
Laypeople / Clients	Simple words and benefits

2. Purpose: Why am I writing?

What should the reader do after reading?

- **Inform:** tell what happened (e.g. progress report)
- **Instruct:** tell how to do something (e.g. installation guide)
- **Persuade:** make someone agree (e.g. proposal)

3. Context: Where and how will it be read?

On a phone, in a meeting or near a machine? Is it urgent? Context decides the **length, look and tone** of the document.

Example: same news, two readers

- **Developer:** "The login fails because the database table has no index."
- **Manager:** "Students cannot log in. It will take 2 days to fix and cost nothing."

Conclusion: When we know the audience, purpose and context, we can write the **right thing** in the **right way**.

Yaad karne ki trick: Kaun parhega? (Audience) · **Kyun** likh raha hoon? (Purpose) · **Kahan/kaise** parhega? (Context)

LONG 2: 7 Cs of Communication

7 Cs notes (Mind Tools)

Q. Explain the 7 Cs of communication with examples.

Introduction

The 7 Cs are a **checklist** for good communication. They make our emails, reports and meetings **clear and effective**.

C	Meaning	Example
1. Clear	Easy to understand; reader does not guess	Say which Daniel and what you want
2. Concise	Short; no extra words	Remove "kind of", "basically"
3. Concrete	Gives exact details	"Packs lunch in 1 minute"
4. Correct	No spelling or grammar mistakes	"two-**week**", not "two-**weak**"
5. Coherent	Logical; one topic in one email	Report and meeting in separate emails
6. Complete	Gives all needed information	Give the meeting **time and place**
7. Courteous	Polite and kind	"Could my team get extra time, please?"

Conclusion: If we follow the 7 Cs, people **understand** us easily and **trust** us.

Yaad karne ki trick: Saaf · Chhota · Pakka · Sahi · Jura · Poora · Tameez
(Clear · Concise · Concrete · Correct · Coherent · Complete · Courteous)

LONG 3: Email Writing

Lecture 1 (slides 13–14) · Class work · 7 Cs

Q. What is a professional email? Explain its parts and write an example.

Introduction

An email is the **most common way** to communicate at work. A good email is **short, clear and polite**.

Parts of a professional email

Part	What to write
1. Subject	What the email is about
2. Salutation	Polite greeting: "Dear Sarah,"
3. Purpose	Why you are writing
4. Details	Dates, times, names
5. Request	What you want, and **by when**
6. Closing	"Thank you," and your name

Bad email vs Good email (slide 14)

Bad email:
Subject: report
Hey, I need the project report ASAP. Send it over now.
Problems: rude, no deadline, no greeting, which report?

Good email:
Subject: Request: Updated Sprint 4 Progress Report
Dear Sarah,
Please send the updated Sprint 4 progress report by 3:00 PM today so we can review it before the client meeting.
Thank you,
Alex
Good points: clear subject, polite greeting, exact time, gives the reason.

Conclusion: A good email follows the **7 Cs**: it is clear, short, complete and polite.

Yaad karne ki trick: S-S-P-D-R-C: "**S**ubject, **S**alaam, **P**urpose, **D**etails, **R**equest, **C**losing"

If the paper says "Write an email to…": use these same 6 parts and only change the topic.

LONG 4: General vs Technical vs Business Writing

Lecture 1 (slides 6, 11, 15–16) · Unit 1 (1.1)

Q. Differentiate between general, technical and business writing.

Definitions

- **Technical writing:** explains technical information **clearly and correctly** to a **specific reader**.
- **Business writing:** writing used **at work** to share information and help **make decisions**.

General vs Technical writing

Basis	General Writing	Technical Writing
Purpose	To entertain	To inform or help do a task
Reader	Anyone	A specific reader
Tone	Emotional	Factual
Structure	Free	Headings, lists, tables
Words	Creative	Exact technical words

Technical vs Business writing

Basis	Technical Writing	Business Writing
Focus	Software and systems	Work and decisions
Documents	Manuals, API docs, SRS	Emails, memos, proposals
Reader	Developers, users	Managers, clients

Both: proposals and feasibility reports are technical **and** business documents.

Conclusion: A computer professional needs **both** technical and business writing.

Yaad karne ki trick: General = **dil** ki baat · Technical = **system** ki baat · Business = **faisle** ki baat

LONG 5: Technical Writing Process

Lecture 2 (slides 4–5) · Unit 1 (1.5)

Q. Explain the stages of the technical writing process.

Introduction

Good writing does not start by just typing. Writers follow **steps**.

Stage	What happens
1. Idea	Choose the topic or problem
2. Planning	Decide the reader, purpose and what to include
3. Gathering	Collect information
4. Reviewing	Check the information is correct and useful
5. Organizing	Put information in order (outline)
6. Drafting	Write the first version
7. Revising	Improve it and finish it

It is a cycle: the writer can **go back** to an earlier step if something is missing. It is not a straight line.

Example: while writing, the writer finds the cost data missing and goes back to collect it.

Conclusion: Following these steps gives a **clear and correct** document.

Yaad karne ki trick: "**I**dea **P**lan **G**ather **R**eview **O**rganize **D**raft **R**evise" → "**I**k **P**akistani **G**har **R**aat **O**r **D**in **R**oshan"